Craft, Care, Create

Proposal Seeking $7,000 in Funding for the Creation and Execution of a Weekend Summer Camp Activities Program for Young Children

Figure 1. Campers enjoying free time at Camp Ker-Anna. Received from https://vimeo.com/1102940107

December 15, 2025

Submitted by Emma Boulanger

Written on behalf of Camp Ker-Anna non-profit organization

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Mark Wahlberg
Grants Manager
Mark Wahlberg Youth Foundation
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Dear Mr. Wahlberg

In this document you will find a formal grant proposal application for your organization, the Mark Wahlberg Youth Foundation, in regards to a weekend summer camp activities program. This program, which will run every other week, on the first and third Saturday of every month, will give children the opportunity to learn important social skills and independence, which a regular classroom cannot achieve. The program, Craft, Care, Create, will support children on their road to success, in finding their identity and building resilience. We are seeking $7,000 for the purchase of equipment, potential staff compensation, and children's fee stipends.

The proposal includes information on our values, objectives, budgeting, and how this program will work to create a deep community working together to better the development of children. Craft, Care, Create strives to be an empowering space for young people to be more confident and approach learning in a fun way. While programs similar to this exist, summer camps and daycares can be expensive for some families, spending on average $300-500 per person, this program intends to make all fees paid for, providing a space for children to learn and grow without financial burdens getting in the way.

Another advantage of such a program would be the opportunities it offers older children who are interested in childcare work, allowing them to approach child development and care from a leadership standpoint. Volunteers could help our program thrive while also adding to their own experience out in the world.

As I explain in my proposal, I have a great deal of expertise in this area, and I am confident in both the necessity and success of such a program. Having attended this camp myself, both as a

camper and volunteer, I am very experienced in this field. I know how much attending a summer camp did for my development, and I see how much it affects our campers every season. The Craft, Care, Create project intends to bring this summer camp experience to those children who might not be able to have the same experience as others.

If you have any further questions about the proposed program or care to arrange a meeting about funding, do not hesitate to contact the mailing address above or email me at camp@keranna.org.

Regards,
Emma Boulanger

Table of Contents

Statement of Problem **5**

Statement of Request **6**

Our Philosophy **8**

Description of Proposed Work **9**

Facilities 9
Activities 9
Personnel 12
Paid Staff 12
Volunteers 13

Timeline **13**

Budget **14**

Employees 15
Equipment 15
Training 16
Other Costs 17

Statement of Success **18**

Summary **18**

Bibliography **20**

Statement of Problem

There is a noticeable impact on children who went to summer camps versus those who did not, emphasizing the importance of providing alternative ways to introduce skills and responsibility. The experience gained by attending a summer camp cannot be compared, but some children simply cannot make the time commitment during the summer.

Schools often do not have the time or capacity to teach important life skills such as responsible decision making, self-management, social awareness, and relationship skills. Often needing to focus on the curriculum and boost students' academic achievement, it is difficult for teachers to include these life-skills into the classroom. Which leads to the importance of summer camps. The opportunities of summer camp is especially important for low-income students, who may not have as many opportunities to gain these important life skills outside of the classroom.

Camps leave a lasting impact on children, providing them with "lifelong memories, new skills, and values" (11 Benefits Of Summer Camps For Kids). Children leave camp with a stronger sense of identity and independence, giving them self-esteem through achievement and resilience.

The experience children receive from summer camps never leaves them, building a basis of themselves that continues to grow throughout their lives. Everything they learned while at summer camp and the resulting actions continue to influence their lives today. My goal is to give every kid a chance at this same experience, specifically during the school months.

According to an article from the Harvard Graduate school of education, summer camps are a key venue for social-emotional learning. There is significant learning campers receive while attending a summer camp that campers and parents do not always recognize. Children's social-emotional skills significantly grow after a session of summer camp, according to the American Camp Association.

Camps are a great way for children to find their own friends, learn problem solving skills without any parent contact. Children can grow and learn in a technology free, new environment. Many after school daycare programs attempt to make the same results as summer camp. And while they may be significant in a child's life, they can also be a financial burden on the parents. With many daycare institutes charging anywhere from $100 - $300 per day, some families simply cannot afford to send their child there. Even some summer camps can be a financial burden. Children's growth is of utmost importance and should be affordable to all people regardless of financial status.

For children who lack the opportunity to attend a summer camp, it is important that they can receive some form of learning that goes on during that time. Without attending a summer camp, children lose the chance to gain independence, build skills, and develop friendships away from the learning classroom. The experience gained in the summer camp space is important for children's independence and social-emotional learning.

Statement of Request

On behalf of Camp Ker-Anna, this project would propose activities supported by summer camps during the school year. The purpose of this project is to support children's growth and give them the best chances in life. This program would provide children with a free space to grow in a positive environment with safety as a primary commitment. Children would be given the opportunity to create lifelong memories and try new things and develop strong problem-solving skills. This program will take place on the weekends during the school year, understanding that some students and children may not be able to commit to time during the summer, but still wanting to give them the experience of attending such a program.

In order to complete this project and fully implement our program, we are requesting support in the form of funding from the Mark Wahlberg Youth Foundation, in the amount of $7,000 for the start-up costs of the Craft, Care, Create program. This grant would provide the program with art and sport supplies that can be used for years to come, as well as cover staff compensation,

program advertising, and the children's fee stipends. Since the Mark Wahlberg Youth Foundation focuses on ensuring "no child is limited or prevented from attaining their lifetime goal or dream due to financial circumstances," we think this weekend summer camp activities program fits in perfectly with the Mark Wahlberg Youth Foundations mission.

This program would run on volunteers and a select few paid staff who are dedicated to this cause. Camp Ker-Anna is a non-profit organization dedicated to ensuring children have a great camp experience. With this program we could expand this goal to help more children everywhere.

Figure 2. Girls playing global ball at Camp Ker-Anna. Received from https://vimeo.com/1102940107.

Our Philosophy

Here at Camp Ker-Anna we value every camper and staff member we have the pleasure of working with. It is our mission to make every camper have a great opportunity to grow, meet new friends, and have fun in the great outdoors.

At Camp Ker-Anna, we follow the three R's: "Respectful, Responsible, Ready to Have Fun". We hold all our staff, family, and campers to this expectation during and outside of the camp season. Our mission is to help young children grow into responsible, confident, and compassionate individuals. This camp is a place where children are accepted and cared for, creating a lasting atmosphere of self-giving and family-like relationships. Our programs are designed to foster personal growth, encourage teamwork, and instill a sense of adventure in young campers.

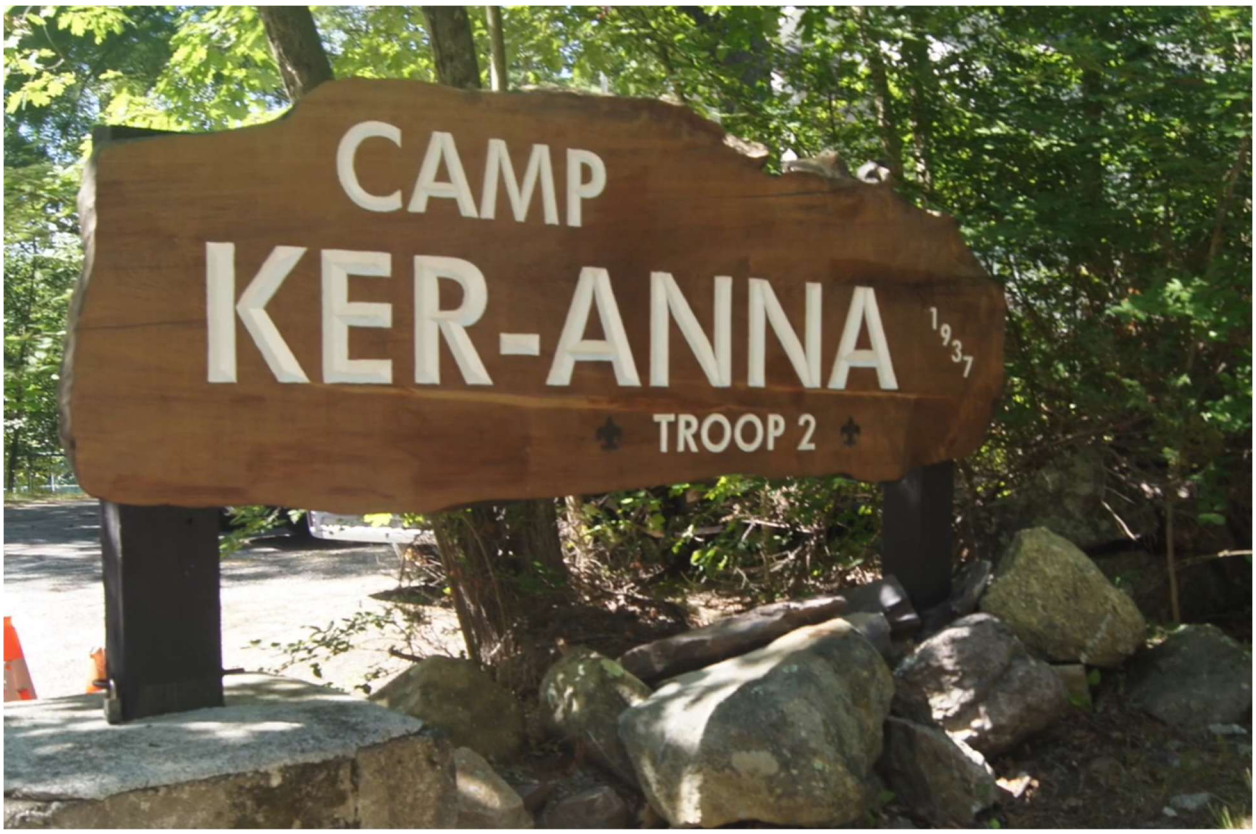

Figure 3. The Camp Ker-Anna sign. Received from https://vimeo.com/1102940107.

Description of Proposed Work

Facilities

This program will take place at Camp Ker-Anna, located in Cumberland Rhode Island, catering to local schools in the area. The program's major objective is to foster learning among young children in a hands-on fun environment. On behalf of Camp Ker-Anna, I am confident that any staff member of Camp Ker-Anna will be able to facilitate to the development of the program.

The facilities being used are all on site of Camp Ker-Anna, with buildings including recreational rooms, a kitchen, a dining room, three cabins, and plenty of woods in the surrounding area to support the functions of this program. The Camp is local to cities such as Cumberland and Attleborough, but far enough away to create a small safe space for children to let loose and have fun. Since the program will take place on our grounds, this will greatly cut the cost of funding for any facility we might have otherwise had to supply.

Activities

The program will be a weekend activities program for young children, ages 9-14, to be in an encouraging small space to explore new activities and meet new people.

To begin, each session will have a maximum of 20 children, allowing for a small sense of community to develop while still exposing them to a wide range of new people. They will be instructed on a special activity that changes every session, relating to an activity one might participate in during normal summer camp hours.

Some examples of activities include but are not limited to:

1. Arts and Crafts
    a. A way to give children a hands-on creative activity, fostering imagination and self-expression.
2. Fishing

    a. Teaching children proper fish handling, catch-and-release ethics, conservation, promoting stronger social connections.
3. Boating
    a. Paddling basics, sailing fundamentals, water safety, while giving children a sense of freedom and exploration and strengthening bonds between friends.
4. Archery
    a. Teaching children patience, and concentration while building self-esteem.
5. Sports
    a. Gives children physical exercise that enhances brain power while building teamwork and resilience.
6. Cooking
    a. Kitchen literacy: basics soft skills like safety, hygiene, nutrition as well as building confidence.
7. Team building games
    a. Working as a team to reach a common goal, while building children's sense of identity.
8. Hiking
    a. Nature walks observing wildlife and fostering care for the environment.
    b.

The activities listed above are just a few examples, not a comprehensive list, of what one session of Craft, Care, Create may be about.

Figure 4. Arts and Crafts at Camp Ker-Anna. Received from https://vimeo.com/1102940107.

The structure of one session would feature individual projects as well as teamwork events, with children of all ages mingling together. There would be one activity chosen per session from the list above to focus on. One example of an activity would be arts and crafts on the picnic tables outside. There would be the staff member giving instructions and examples, then the volunteers would walk around helping any child who may have questions for issues. I think this is an effective way to run such a program for the following reasons;

- One staff member will be able to assess all prospects of the activity, without the need to switch between topics, creating a lull between groups. This would also greatly reduce the number of personnel needed per session.
- The group setting with individual projects would allow for children to work on their own while being in a group setting interacting with others. Working as a group with different age groups will give individuals the chance to find their place and set a common ground for helping others.

Since this program runs throughout the school year, weather conditions such as snow or rain will affect which sessions have different activities. Taking into account for the coldness of the winter

months, indoor activities would take place during this time, whereas the warmer months of fall and spring, activities would be held outdoors.

Personnel

Though this program will rely heavily on volunteers from either the schools attending the program or previous Camp Ker-Anna volunteers, there are some people who are pivotal for this project to work.

Paid Staff

There will be one important paid position, the Program Coordinator. The Program Coordinator will be Emma Boulanger. As Program Coordinator, Emma will oversee all training, interviews, and meetings related to the Craft, Care, Create project. She will communicate with the summer camp program to ensure smooth running and addressing any issues that come up. She will be our main outlet for promote the program through the advertisements mentioned earlier. As a lifelong member of the Camp Ker-Anna family, someone who was once a camper from ages 5 - 14, a member of junior staff, and is now a member of senior staff for girls overnight, a Bake and Festival volunteer, as well as one of our Camp Cooks, Emma is uniquely qualified to represent this project and is passionate to support the needs of the program. Her experience with leading campers and maintain all safety procedures will help her … from planning activities to delegating others to acquire anything needed. Since this job would require her presence for hours only on weekends and some nights for meetings, this is the perfect occupation for such a qualified woman who is currently an undergraduate at the University of Massachusetts Amherst.

There will be one staff member per session who is designated as the Activities Coordinator of each certain activity. These staff members will consist of members of the Camp Ker-Anna staff, a trusted member willing to rise to help this program come to life. This staff member will be trained in their responsibilities as well as plan for their activity, preparing any equipment and briefing any helpers they may have.

All members of the staff will need to be trained in CPR and First Aid, to be able to manage any circumstances that may arise, according to our Camp policies.

Volunteers

For each session, there will be three to five volunteers to aid the staff member in guiding the children through the activity. These volunteers will be responsible for making sure all children participating in the activity are safe, respectful, and, most importantly, having fun. These volunteers will attend meetings related to their activity session, helping in preparation and setting up the activity. The purpose of volunteering is to relieve some pressure from staff members running the activity.

Timeline

Considering the academic and camp seasons, the expected timeline for this project, in order to be fully implemented for the fall school year, is one academic semester. Thus, on behalf of Camp Ker-Anna, I am asking for a grant to cover the costs of one season this program is in effect, which will include:

April 2026 – June 2026

- Initial hiring of all appropriate staff members
- Hold interviews for all potential volunteers
- Train all volunteers and staff members accordingly with compliance with camp policies
- Advertising in our monthly newsletter

July 2026 – Early August 2026

- Advertising during summer camp season
- Purchasing all necessary equipment
- Setting up intake form for children
- Meetings with volunteers and staff members to ensure good teamwork for duration of the program

Early September 2026 – Late April 2027

- Preparation for activities
- Two activities per month
- Monthly meetings with volunteers and staff to ensure teamwork and upkeep of this program
- Reflection on past activities

In order to get the word out about this program we will need to start advertising, as previously mentioned above, in April. This will be through our monthly newsletter that goes out to all camp families promoting news surrounding the upcoming season and holiday events. In addition, we will also cater to local schools through posters and posting on our social media pages, to get the most traction. During the camp season, there will be announcements during parent programs to introduce the new program, mentioning as much detail as possible and having a booth with intake forms ready to go for anyone wishing to sign up or donate anything.

As will be mentioned later, training for all employees and volunteers will take place at the same time as our summer camp training, to cut costs and time regulations. All volunteer and paid staff will be included in monthly meetings to prepare for the upcoming season, making sure everyone knows what they are doing and making final preparations for scheduled activities.

Once the program begins, there will be two activities every other weekend from September to April. They will be Saturdays afternoons, 1 – 4 p.m., to accommodate for everyone's schedules. This schedule will cover all sessions of the program, at the discretion of the Program Coordinator and staff.

Budget

In total, we need at least $7,000 to account for the total cost of running this program for a year. The budget below accounts for the hourly wage of our employees, the supplies and equipment for our activities, children's fee stipends, and training required for all personnel. Fortunately, so many people in our camp familyare enthusiastic about donating their time and some supplies towards bettering child development, so some of these costs may be cut by volunteer work.

Employees

We need to pay our Program Coordinator for their work in arranging and running the entire program. If Emma worked roughly 110 hours per season and was paid at a standard rate of $20 per hour, we would need to pay her $2,200 a year in total.

Our schedule demands that we would need at least one staff member present for each activity in the program, which would be three hours every other Saturday from 1 – 4 p.m. If we paid this staff member $150 per activity, assuming this staff member would work one in every four sessions, we would need to pay $600 for each staff member. In total for all paid staff members, we would pay an estimate of $2,400 per program season.

There are also several nearby schools and camp families that are a large part of our continued success as a non-profit organization. We could offer older children and students the opportunity to teach and learn how to manage a particular setting, while fueling our goal of providing a safe and fun environment for everyone. This could be such a good opportunity for students, especially those looking into childcare or elementary teaching jobs, we could open the program up for volunteering, as we do during our camp season already. During the summer, our camp program receives about 40 volunteers for our day camp program, as well as an additional 40 volunteers for our overnight camp program. Our camp offers this opportunity for students to get volunteer hours as well as community service hours they can use for National Honor Society and their resume, we have quite a few people already participating in this way. This extra help would ease the paid employees' task of keeping track of all the children at no cost.

Equipment

Another thing we must pay for is the supplies needed for each activity, ranging from cooking materials to sports equipment, to arts and craft supplies. With our advertising goal, we hope to receive some donations from families to help cut the costs of materials, however we cannot rely on this entirely.

Each activity in this program has a slightly different need. Arts and crafts, for instance, can be very intuitive, with children's imagination running free, taking whatever is in front of them and changing it into something unique. One example of an arts and craft project would be to have each child make a dreamcatcher. The supplies needed would include string, a hoop of metal or wood, beads, scissors, small metal tubes. Each set of supplies would cost roughly $15 for each child per session, with around 20 children, that would be a total of $300 for art supplies per session. Assuming the average price of art costs would remain the same, as well as the cost per arts and craft session, the total amount needed would be $600 for one year of the program.

Figure 5. Girls making shadowboxes at Camp Ker-Anna. Received from https://vimeo.com/1102940107.

Sports equipment can be expensive to buy equipment for. The average price of one dodgeball is $10, with regular wear and tear, these need to be replaced almost every year. If we buy ten dodgeballs, the average cost for this sport alone would be $100 each year. Other sports like team handball, tetherball, basketball, street hockey, have an average of $20 for their respective equipment. We would need to spend around $200 for sports equipment each year in the program.

Cooking has a wide variety of equipment needed. Perhaps the most expensive would be the ingredients needed for the activity. Taking into account the materials such as utensils, pans, bowls, all of which are already in possession of, the only other cost would be the food. Having each child bake and frost their own cupcake would cost roughly $10 per child. Factoring in the baking/time costs and running this activity for one year in the program, the cost for this equipment would be $200 per program season.

In total, we need about $1,000 for all equipment.

Training

Every employee and volunteer will need to be trained in CPR, First Aid, and Behavioral training. The cost of First Aid/CPR according to the National CPR Foundation Website is roughly $12 for

each certification, which is valid for up to two years. This would come out to be around $25 per person. Assuming that we have 20 volunteers in total, as well as four paid employees, the total cost for one year of training would be around $600.

Behavioral training will be done through Camp Ker-Anna at the same time as our summer camp training courses, this training will cover special circumstances and how to manage new situations and sensitive information these children may have. This training is a safeguard for our staff to be comfortable handling situations on their own, preventing any problems from happening. Since this training will be done entirely through Camp Ker-Anna, there is no additional cost for this training.

The total amount we need to cover training costs is roughly $600 for up to two years of certification.

Other Costs

With the $7,000 grant, we would have $800 left over to cover the children's fee stipends as well as any incidental costs that come with running a summer camp program and maintaining the space year-round. Thankfully, our newsletter and email platform will allow us to share specific information about each session with parents and volunteers, as well as texting important follow ups with personnel as needed. However, not all people have such technology, so we could also offer printouts of the activity information to those who need it using the money left over. We could also use these funds to raise awareness of the summer camp activities program through advertisements and posters.

Statement of Success

Our primary goal of this project is providing a fun and captivating learning environment for children who lack opportunities during the summer months to attend a summer camp. This program focuses on ensuring each child has an opportunity to find themselves and make connections to last a lifetime.

The success of this program is measured by the number of parents and children who decide to come back in the following years. Success is about the children, the memories and skills they gain through our program. It is our most important mission that each child who attends the Craft, Care, Create program receives something special, something they will keep with them for the rest of their lives.

Summary

If the Mark Wahlberg Youth Foundation chooses to support and help fund the Craft, Care, Create Program, they would be giving children from all over northern Rhode Island and southern Massachusetts the opportunity to grow and learn self-identity without any financial burdens. These children will develop strong problem-solving skills, patience, basic life skills, while being surrounded by children sharing experiences, and adults passionate about their role in helping these children develop into powerful people. We will give volunteers the chance to find their passion, build their resumes while supporting a great project. This program will bring summer camp to the school year, allowing children from any background to be part of something great.

We at Craft, Care, Create strongly believe in the power a summer camp has and the benefits it could provide to young children who have busy summer schedules. Free from financial burdens,

giving children every opportunity regardless of any status. We are dedicated to our cause and will do anything to give better opportunities to young children in this area. Will you help us achieve this?

Figure 6. Girls Week 1 Junior staff photo 2025. Received from https://vimeo.com/1102940107.

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All images taken by Emma Boulanger from the Camp Ker-Anna Girls Week 1 video.